against the existing position of disadvantage for TTSL. I have not been able to find any conversation projected by the media which subverts policy, or seeks any illegal or unfair favors or connives to select or remove any minister or officer in the ministry or confabulates to topple any Government … Even more disturbing is the revelation that the entire media campaign is, without a doubt, a very well-organized endeavour to divert attention away from the real scam, namely the major deviations of Government policy in telecom and the exploitation of such policies by a few powerful telecom operators.'

While some in the media were aware that the Tatas were being targeted by some powerful lobbies, the group continued to be at the receiving end of accusations. For instance, a magazine article commented, 'On paper, the House of Tatas benefited most from the Telecom scam.' As a senior journalist said, 'Ratan Tata really got hammered.' According to him, the tapes were given to journalists, including himself, by a 'lobbyist belonging to a very powerful business family'. This corroborated Ratan's oft-repeated plea that the Tata Group was a victim of the machinations of a telecom company.

The journalist added, 'What they [editors of the papers that chose to publish the transcripts] didn't know, and what they probably don't know even today, is the fact that there are conversations of Ratan Tata where he actually tells Niira Radia that "Niira, this is [the] Tata Group. We do not pay people under the table."'

Ratan further said in an interview that in the end, such wanton attacks on corporates were only harming the country's 'investment climate' and he feared that ultimately such an environment would disadvantage the country. 'If we don't put an end to this kind of thing [leaking private conversations to the public] and under the guise of freedom of speech or the guise of many other numbers of so-called rights of democracy, [we abuse] the luxury of a democracy.'

On 29 November, three days after Ratan wrote to the Prime Minister and the finance minister, he moved the Supreme Court under Article 32, which guarantees the freedom to approach the Supreme Court directly where there is a violation of Fundamental Rights. He sought its intervention to stop the publication of his conversation with Radia on the ground that they did not reveal any illegal action or attempt on his part. The conversations had either been conducted in the course of legitimate business activities or were purely